MIL-P-37055
6 May 1974

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

PLUG, EAR, HEARING PROTECTION, CYLINDRICAL, SILICONE BASE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers cylindrical ear plugs suitable for use as hearing protectors against high level noise sources.

1.2 Classification. Ear plugs shall be furnished in the following sizes, as indicated below (see 6.1).

a - Size 1 (1 inch)

b - Size 2 (3/4 inch)

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

PPP-B-585	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	Boxes, Set-up.

Military

MIL-P-116	Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-L-10547	Liners, Case, and Sheet Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

FSC 6515

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STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards, required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Shall be a light pink color, soft, elastomeric, uncured, silicone based material. Shall be non-toxic when used externally.

3.2 Construction. Each pair of size 1 ear plugs shall be attached side to side. Each pair of size 2 ear plugs shall be attached end to end. Each ear plug shall be cylindrical in shape.

3.3 Moldability. Shall be capable of being readily molded with the fingers to the shape and contour of all ear channels so as to form an airtight seal. Shall be capable of being easily and readily removed from the ear.

3.4 Dimensions.

3.4.1 Diameter. The diameter of each ear plug shall be 3/8 ± 1/16 inches.

3.4.2 Length. Type I ear plugs shall be 1 ± 1/16 inches in length. Type II ear plugs shall be 3/4 ± 1/16 inch long.

3.5 Weight. Each size 1 ear plug shall weigh 2.1 ± 0.1 grams. Each size 2 ear plug shall weigh 1.6 ± 0.1 grams.

3.6 High Temperature Test. Ear plugs shall retain their original appearance and moldability with the fingers after exposure to high temperature as specified in 4.4.1.

3.7 Low Temperature Test. Ear plugs shall retain their initial plasticity when tested at low temperature as specified in 4.4.2.

3.8 Instructions for use. Instructions for use shall be provided with each pair of ear plugs.

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3.9 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The ear plugs shall be clean and free from any defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in Table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one ear plug.

Table I. Sampling Criteria for Examination

Type defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	S-3	2.5
Minor	S-3	4.0

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in Table II.

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Table II. Sampling Criteria for Tests

Component	Characteristic	Reqm't.	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL
Ear plug	Dimensions	3.4.1 and 3.4.2		S-1	1.0
	Weight	3.5		S-1	1.0
	High temperature test	3.6	4.4.1	**	*
	Low temperature test	3.7	4.4.2	**	*

* Acceptance number shall be zero.
** Ten individual ear plugs shall be tested regardless of lot size.

4.3 Examination. The ear plugs shall be examined to determine compliance with all the requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in Tables I and III. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in Table III. Any units in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected and if the number of defective units in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for the sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

Table III. Classification of Defects

Categories	Defects
Major	
101	Dimensions not as specified.
102	Weight not as specified.
103	Ear plug not soft and malleable.
104	Complete instructions wording not present on individual blister pack.
Minor	
201	Labeling not present, complete, correct, or legible.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 High temperature test. Ten individual ear plugs from each lot shall be heated in an hot air oven for ten minutes at 350°F, then allowed to cool to room temperature and examined for moldability and general appearance.

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4.4.2 Low temperature test. Ten individual ear plugs from each lot shall be kept in a refrigerator at -20°F. for four hours, removed from the refrigerator and immediately tested for plasticity by molding with the fingers.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be Level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One package containing 200 plugs of size 1 or one package containing 48 plugs of size 2 as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Packaging quantities. The number of units of issue indicated in Table IV shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container, as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

Table IV. Packaging Quantities

Size	Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
1	1 unit	Not required	50 units
2	1 unit	Not required	72 units

5.1.2.1 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units in the entire shipment is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which shall insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 Level A.

5.1.3.1 Unit package.

5.1.3.1.1 Size 1. Two hundred (200) plugs shall be packaged in pairs in a suitable plastic blister on a continuous dispenser belt. The dispenser belt of 100 pairs shall be further packaged in a box of appropriate size and design constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676. Closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.3.1.2 Size 2. Two (2) plugs shall be packaged in a suitable plastic box. Forty eight (48) plugs (24 packaged pairs) shall be further packaged in a box of appropriate size and design constructed in accordance with PPP-B-676 or PPP-B-636 class domestic. Closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

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5.1.4 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be Level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V3c. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Special requirements of applicable table shall apply for PPP-B-636 box.

5.2.1.2 Case liner. Each Level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Fiberboard box shall be waterproof in accordance with paragraph 30.4 of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Fiberboard box shall be closed by method II of PPP-B-636. Special requirements of applicable table shall apply for PPP-B-636 box.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Interior packages. Each unit package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise the desired options offered herein, and the procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Size required (see 1.2).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.2 This specification covers the following items appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog.

National Stock No.	Item Identification
6515-00-133-5416	PLUG, EAR, Hearing Protection, Clindrical, Disposable, 200s
6515-00-135-2416	PLUG, EAR, Hearing Protection, Clindrical, 48s

It does not include all types or sizes as indicated by the title nor all types which are commercially available.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review activities:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6515-1828

Review information is current as of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on information in the current DODISS.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval No. 22 R255

INSTRUCTIONS. The purpose of this form is to solicit beneficial comments which will help achieve procurement of suitable products at reasonable cost and minimum delay, or will otherwise enhance use of the document. DoD contractors, government activities, or manufacturers/vendors who are prospective suppliers of the product are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE: MIL-P-37055

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

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